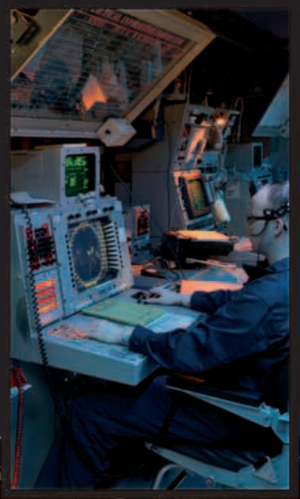
BELOW DECKS

THE AEGIS COMBAT SYSTEM at the heart of the ship's operations detects incoming missile and aircraft threats and deploys countermeasures, missiles, and gunfire. The ship's AN/SPY 1-D phased array radar can track hundreds of targets simultaneously. There are steel bulkheads throughout the ship in case a hit is suffered, and especially vital equipment is given extra armor by Kevlar shields. An air filtration system forms part of the comprehensive protection against nuclear, biological, and chemical attack. The gas turbine engines are derived from the engines used on jet airliners such as the Boeing 747.



» Main passageway
Double-plated bulkheads and interior air-lock doors provide protection and allow vital areas—such as the Central Control Station at the end of this corridor—to be isolated.



« Tactical Coordinator
The CIC is manned by a team of highly trained specialists, each with a specific role to play. The Tactical Information Coordinator seen here, for example, handles tactical data coming in from allied ships.



» Airtight hatch
To protect the ship and crew against contamination from chemical or biological agents, the Collective Protection System (CPS) divides the ship into zones, separated by airtight hatches, enabling the crew to maintain a pressurized, filtered environment.





« » Combat Information Center
The Combat Information Center (CIC), the tactical heart of the ship, is dominated by the AEGIS combat system, an advanced computer-based control and information system that integrates the data coming in from the radar and satellite systems and controls the ship's weapons and electronic countermeasures.

» Enlisted mess
Enlisted men on *Donald Cook* eat most of their meals in an informal self-service cafeteria next to the ship's galley. Officers have a separate mess.



» Ship's galley
The spacious and well-equipped kitchens on board *Donald Cook* allow the galley staff to prepare three hot meals a day, with a choice of dishes, for a crew of over 300 officers and enlisted men.

